

Mindfulness Matters: Fostering Conflict Resilient Teams

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Research Question

How does participation in an original workplace mindfulness training program influence team effectiveness and conflict resilience among non-profit social workers?

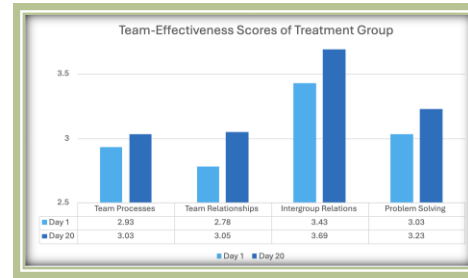
Background

- Our pilot study explores what components of team-effectiveness and conflict resolution improve after a 20-day mindfulness program comprised of 10-minute daily exercises.
- Mindfulness is defined as the awareness that arises from paying attention on purpose, in the present moment without being judgmental (Kabat-Zinn, 2003). Since mindfulness reduces symptoms of stress and has an essential role in improving personal relationships (Janovsky et al., 2019; Somohano, 2013).
- Nonprofit organizations frequently face resource constraints, limiting their access to comprehensive professional development opportunities including wellness/healthcare programs. By offering accessible mindfulness training, we seek to address this gap and empower nonprofit teams to cultivate a culture of mindfulness and resilience.
- The higher levels of mindfulness improve the effects of polychronicity, and enhance work and home life satisfaction, and conflict control (Weintraub et al., 2019).

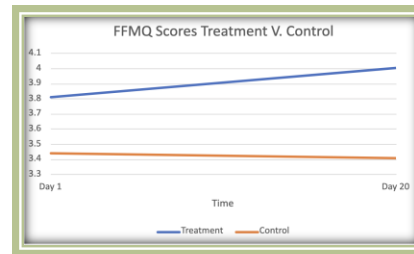
Materials and Participants

- Adults at a small non-profit organization located in Spokane. Total participants: 11
- 2 sessions where participants completed 3 questionnaires (FFMQ, conflict handling style, and team effectiveness) and were interviewed.
- A 40-page mindfulness training packet was printed and distributed to all 7 participants on day 1 (see program).
- 7 participants were given the program, while the other 4 served as our control group, limiting their access to comprehensive

Results



Four facets from: "Team Effectiveness Diagnostic" created by London Leadership Academy, National Health Service



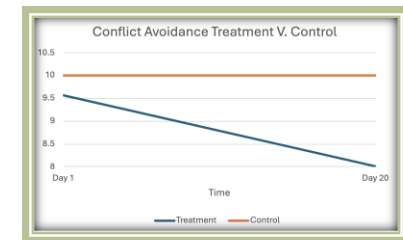
Results from FFMQ-Using self-report assessment methods to explore facets of mindfulness. Assessment, 13(1), 27-45.



Quoted feedback from treatment group-Day 20

Key Findings

- The treatment group displayed enhancements in team processes, relationships, intergroup dynamics, and problem-solving; however, these discoveries did not reach statistical significance. The control group showed no measurable benefits.
- Conflict resolution styles remained unchanged post-training, except for decreased conflict avoidance in the treatment group.
- FFMQ scores notably improved in the treatment group, particularly in observing and acting with awareness facets.



Data measured by Rahim's organizational conflict inventory.

The avoiding style, also known as suppression, indicates low concern for self and others.

Discussion/Limitations

• **Importance:** Our pilot study confirms the effectiveness of accessible mindfulness training for conflict resolution in non-profits, echoing the growing understanding of mindfulness as a vital self-care strategy for human service workers (McGarigle & Walsh, 2011).

• Mindfulness practices implemented in the workplace can foster tangible improvements in employee well-being, productivity, and overall organizational culture.

• The program's strengths lie in its accessibility, flexibility, and personalized approach. Participants found the exercises easy to access and could practice them at their convenience, fitting into their daily lives.

• **Limitations:** The findings are limited by the small sample size, affecting the generalizability and reliability of the results. The brief duration of the program may have restricted the breadth of its impact and the ability to fully assess its effectiveness.